Responsible AI Use

1 Introduction

The purpose of this document is to provide guidance on the appropriate, ethical, and responsible use of Generative Artificial Intelligence (AI) in academic and professional settings.ChatGPT, Gemini, Copilot, and other forms of Generative Artificial Intelligence (AI) can produce text, code, images, and other media. These tools can be valuable for brainstorming, organizing ideas, finding information, and creating drafts or visual materials. However, they must be used appropriately,ethically and with awareness of their limitations. Regardless of how you use AI, you are ultimately responsible for the final quality, accuracy, and integrity of your work both in academic settings and in your professional life.

Generative AI is powerful and increasingly integrated into everyday applications, but it also has important limitations that you must understand.

Lack of transparency: The internal process behind AI-generated outputs cannot be fully determined or traced.

Potential for bias or inaccuracy: Because AI systems are trained on existing online data, their responses may reflect bias, misinformation, or even fabricated content that appears factual.

Intellectual property concerns: The sources and ownership of AI-generated material are often unclear, raising questions about authorship, attribution, and citation responsibilities.

The Responsible adoption of AI in academia must go hand-in-hand with protecting the ecosystem of human knowledge and maintaining critical thinking, expertise, and scientific integrity (Guest2025 [1]). These guidelines therefore balance innovation with caution, ensuring that the use of generative tools strengthens not replaces learning and inquiry.

2 Usage Philosophy: Responsible and Ethical Use

The goal of using AI in your academic work is not to shortcut learning; it is to improve how you think, create, and solve problems. Students should hone their writing, thinking, and other academic skills at every opportunity ... writing

creates a space for students to assimilate and create knowledge independently of industry influence(Guest2025 [1]). These principles are meant to help you use AI confidently, responsibly, and with integrity, so that your work remains your own while benefiting from the support these tools can offer.

AI should help you think, not think for you. Use AI to brainstorm ideas, explore code options, clarify complex topics, or analyze problems. Do not use them to do your work for you. Do not copy its answers or use them to complete assignments without your input. When you outsource thinking, you outsource learning (Ji,2025 as quoted in [1]) warning that over-reliance on AI risks deskilling students and educators alike. The purpose of AI use, therefore, is to enhance critical engagement.

You are fully responsible for what you submit. You are responsible for everything you submit AI tools don't share that responsibility. Always verify facts, code, and sources yourself, if you can not confirm something, delete it. Treat AI outputs as unverified until checked and ensure that your final work reflects your understanding, not the AI's.

Transparency Is Non-Negotiable. Be open about when and how you used AI, honesty builds trust, and protects your integrity. Clearly state the tool, what you used it for, and how you verified the results. All AI use must be documented and explained in your submission.

Respect Privacy and Ethics. Never upload confidential or personal information such as grades, IDs, or data to AI tools. These systems may store or share conversations externally, so treat them always as public spaces. Protect yourself and others by keeping sensitive data offline and using only safe, non-identifiable examples.

Be Critical, Reflective, and Ethical AI can be confident and wrong, reflect bias, or miss context it predicts, it doesn't know. Treat outputs as a starting point, not a final answer. Always verify claims with reliable sources, test code, question results, and stay alert to bias or missing context. Do not accept the first answer, copy without checking, or share sensitive data that violate privacy or course policies.

3 Settings and Principles (Using AI Well)

How you use AI matters as much as how you use it. These settings and habits help you get meaningful, reliable and ethical support from AI tools, turning them into learning partners, not shortcuts.

Personalization ON (when available) Enable personalization features so the AI can remember context from your ongoing work, such as topics you have discussed, learning goals, or preferred styles, making interactions more consistent and efficient. Use this feature only for general context you are comfortable sharing, and never include private, sensitive, or identifying information.

Study/Learning Mode (or equivalent) Prefer modes that explain step-by-step reasoning, show intermediate steps, and surface alternatives this is for learning, not just answers. You may use any mode you like, as long as you

prompt it to explain, justify, and compare options (not just dump a result). Avoid one shot answers; ask for reasoning, checks, and next steps.

Role Alignment Clearly tell the AI what role you want it to play such as a tutor, code reviewer, or writing coach so that its responses match your learning goals. The role helps the AI tailor explanations, feedback, and structure to what you need. It's about guiding the tool to support your thinking, not replace it.

Iterative Use Use AI as part of an ongoing conversation, not a one-time query. Start broad to explore ideas, then ask follow up questions that dig deeper, clarify reasoning, or test assumptions. Treat each response as a draft to refine, challenge, and build on it until you fully understand the concept or solution.

4 Guideline Specifics

Note: These guidelines are intended to promote responsible, transparent, and ethical use of AI tools in academic work. Failing to follow them can result in concerns related to academic integrity, including questions about authorship, originality, or misuse of technology. Students are expected to uphold the same standards of honesty, accuracy, and accountability when using AI as they would for any other academic resource.

Writing and Presentation You may include AI-assisted content if (and only if) you clearly document the use. Acceptable support includes outlining, drafting sections, reorganizing text, eliminating redundancy, and formatting citations. Your submission must meet standards for attribution, accuracy, and validation. As (Guest2025 [1]) points out, LLMs do not improve one's writing ability much like taking a taxi does not improve one's driving ability. Students should hone their writing, thinking, and other academic skills at every opportunity.AI should support, not substitute, the act of learning through writing

Multimedia (images, audio, music, video) AI-generated media may be used with transparent documentation of how it was created/edited and how you verified originality, permissions, and accuracy

Quantitative work (math/stats/data analysis/coding/interpretation) AI may help with ideas, syntax, or debugging. You must verify all results with your own calculations/tests and include proof of work (e.g.,. code). If the results cannot be reproduced, do not submit them.

Readings and Discussions AI can help you analyze or summarize the readings, but it is not a substitute for doing the readings. Unless explicitly permitted, do not submit AI-written discussion posts. Your contributions must be your own thinking.

Research AI may support topic brainstorming, search strategies, source evaluation, summaries, and organization. Track how you used AI throughout your process and disclose it at the time of submission. Never cite AI as a source of fact—locate and cite the primary source instead. Using AI products to generate academic content is against any conceivable set of rules we already have in place to regulate fraud ... Failure to see this buys into the hype (Guest2025 [1]).

Simulations You may use AI for advice or brainstorming. Do not use it to gain an unfair advantage or cheat. If a report is required, disclose how AI was used so that your process is transparent.

Group Work Follow the relevant category above (e.g., group writing uses writing rules). Document AI use at the group level to ensure transparency across all contributors. As (Guest2025 [1]) warns, uncritical or undisclosed use of AI risks "deskilling the whole academic profession, a direct threat to the ecosystem of human knowledge". Collaborative projects should, therefore, emphasize shared understanding and authentic contribution from every member, not collective dependence on automated tools.

In-Class Activities Use AI only as directed by the instructor for that activity.

Exams (written/oral) AI is prohibited unless your instructor explicitly allows it. If allowed, you must still follow the rules above.

5 Sourcing, Documentation, and Reflection on AI Use

Accuracy and Verification AI tools can generate incorrect or biased results. You are responsible for checking every piece of information, code, or calculation before submission. Always validate outputs with credible sources, course materials, or your own analysis. If you cannot verify something as factual, remove it.

Attribution and Citation All significant AI use must be cited, similar to how you would reference other external sources. When AI meaningfully contributes to an assignment (e.g., providing ideas, clarifying concepts, drafting text, or suggesting code), include a short statement describing:

- The tool used (e.g., ChatGPT, Gemini, Copilot)
- How you used it (e.g., brainstorming, debugging, editing)
- What you verified or modified afterward

Reflection on AI Use Each major project should include a short reflection (2-4 sentences or one brief paragraph) describing your personal experience using AI. Address the following points:

- **Time Efficiency:** Did using AI save time or add extra steps? How did it affect your workflow?
- **Performance and Accuracy:** Did AI improve your results, or did you find errors you had to fix?
- **Understanding and Learning:** Did interacting with AI deepen your grasp of the topic, or just speed up the process?

References

[1] Guest, Olivia and Suarez, Marcela and Müller, Barbara and van Meerkerk, Edwin and Beverborg, Arnoud Oude Groote and de Haan, Ronald and Elizondo, Andrea Reyes and Blokpoel, Mark and Scharfenberg, Natalia and Kleinherenbrink, Annelies and others (2025). *Against the Uncritical Adoption of 'AI' Technologies in Academia*.

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The development of these guidelines was informed by the *UNC Generative AI Student Guidelines (UNC AI Committee)* and the *Guidance for AI in Education: A Landscape Analysis.* These materials provided valuable insights into responsible, ethical, and educationally sound practices for incorporating AI into academic contexts.